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1. Taj Rishikesh Resort & Spa, nestled in the Himalayan foothills
2. VILEEN Rishikesh combines natural surroundings with wellness experiences rooted in Himalayan traditions
3. Siddha Wellness Village, tucked away in Faridabad, Haryana



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sandhyas (evenings of hymns), *navgraha havans* (worshipping the nine celestial planets), guided walks through Haridwar's bazaars, culinary trails, and vegetarian menus rooted in heirloom recipes and regional traditions.

HERITAGE AS LUXURY

Hospitality companies are also broadening the definition of spiritual travel beyond pilgrimage towns. One example is Noor Mahal Delhi NCR Karnal's Autograph Collection, Marriott Bonvoy's first Autograph Collection property in India. Located on the historic Grand Trunk Road, the 176-key palace

hotel positions itself an "immersive journey through India's civilisational heritage" with every corridor, dome, mural, and artefact curated to function as part museum, part living cultural experience.

Less than an hour away lies Kurukshetra, revered as the battlefield where Lord Krishna delivered the Bhagavad Gita to Arjuna—one of the world's most influential spiritual discourses and a focal point of the government's Krishna Circuit tourism initiative.

Rather than treating nearby heritage sites as optional excursions, the hotel integrates them into the guest journey.

"At Noor Mahal, our vision is to forge a deep and authentic connection with the region's rich cultural heritage and surroundings. As a real palace experience, we curate immersive journeys through a highly personalised service. Every detail—from our grand venues to our meticulously crafted culinary offerings—is designed to create unforgettable moments and redefine the guest experience," elaborates Mahesh Singh Jasrotia, General Manager.

Guests may begin the day at the spa, spend the afternoon exploring Kurukshetra's sacred landscapes or nearby Buddhist sites, and return to a palace that celebrates India's artistic traditions, adds Jasrotia. "We do not view spirituality solely through the prism of religion or ritual. We believe it lies in creating spaces that inspire reflection, foster meaningful connections, celebrate India's extraordinary heritage, and allow guests to experience the richness of our civilisation at their own pace."

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COMMERCIAL IN THE COSMIC

Given the market dynamics, the International Market Analysis Research and Consulting (IMARC), a private international research firm, estimates that India's religious and spiritual market size, valued at \$70.14 billion in 2025, will almost double to \$135.41 billion by 2034 by growing at a compound annual growth rate of 7.58%.

The market is driven by deeply rooted cultural traditions, increasing disposable incomes, growing interest in spiritual wellness and mindfulness practices, and expanding pilgrimage infrastructure, adds the report. Government initiatives promoting religious tourism circuits, enhanced connectivity to sacred destinations,